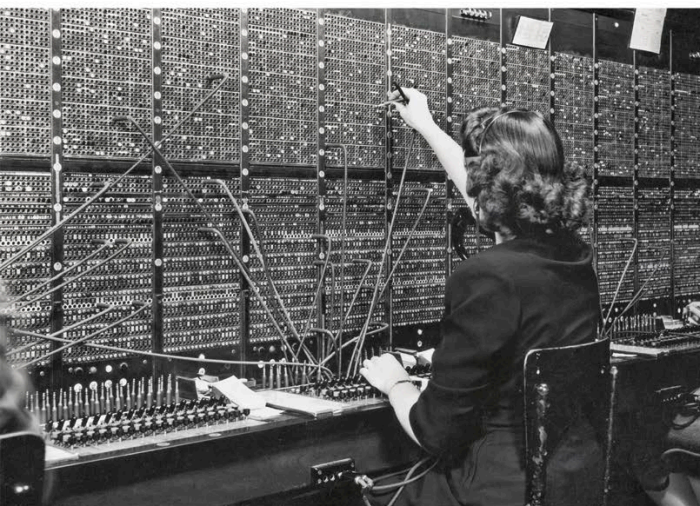




◀ GETTING CONNECTED

Callers would lift the phone and ask an exchange for the number they wanted, then the operator plugged the line into a switchboard to make the connection.

THE TELEPHONE EXCHANGE

Early telephones came in pairs and connected only with each other. It needed the invention of a central exchange, to which all local telephones were connected, to allow any person to call any other.



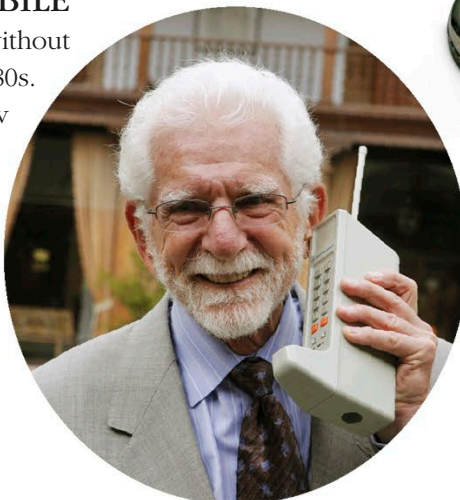
▲ AUTOMATIC TELEPHONE EXCHANGE PHONE

This 1905 phone was designed for use with an automatic exchange, which first appeared in 1889.

GOING MOBILE

The first portable phones without cords appeared in the early 1980s.

Networks had relatively few radio frequencies, but millions of users, and calls could be handled automatically without an operator.



Dr. Martin Cooper with the first portable handset



TEXTING

The first text message ever sent was in 1992 and read "Happy Christmas." Texting was slow to catch on—the first phone with a full keyboard did not appear until 1996.

